Reading Comprehension Mock Exam

Main ideas, details, inference, vocabulary, and purpose.

70 original multiple-choice practice questions ? Choose the best answer for each item.

Unofficial practice material created for ScholarHunt. This is not an official scholarship examination.

1. A school garden grows vegetables for the cafeteria. Students take turns watering and recording plant growth. What is the main idea?

A. Students help maintain a garden that supplies the cafeteria
B. The cafeteria serves only vegetables
C. Teachers measure rainfall every day
D. The garden is closed to students

2. Nina packed a raincoat after hearing a weather alert for heavy showers. What can be inferred?

A. She wanted to be prepared for rain
B. She planned to go swimming
C. The alert promised sunshine
D. She had lost her backpack

3. A library added evening hours after students said they needed a quiet place to study. Why did the library extend its hours?

A. To meet students' study needs
B. To reduce its collection
C. To hold sports practice
D. To shorten the school day

4. The path was muddy, so the hikers walked slowly and watched their footing. What does "muddy" suggest about the path?

A. It was wet and possibly slippery
B. It was perfectly dry
C. It was covered in snow
D. It was made of smooth glass

5. A paper plane flew farther when its wings were folded evenly. What is the likely conclusion?

A. Balanced folds helped the plane fly farther
B. The paper became heavier
C. The plane used a motor
D. The room had no air

6. Lina reviewed her notes in short sessions across several days. On quiz day, she remembered more than when she had crammed. Which idea is supported?

A. Spaced review can support memory
B. Notes are never useful
C. Cramming always improves memory

D. Quizzes measure handwriting only

7. The bus arrived late because a road was closed for repairs. What caused the delay?

A. The road closure
B. A new bus route
C. A school holiday
D. A missing ticket

8. After the rain, sunlight appeared and a rainbow formed. What condition helped produce the rainbow?

A. Sunlight and water droplets in the air
B. Dry air and darkness
C. Strong wind alone
D. Dust under the ground

9. Marco borrowed a dictionary to check the meaning and pronunciation of an unfamiliar word. What was his purpose?

A. To understand how the word is used and said
B. To find a bus schedule
C. To calculate a distance
D. To look up a recipe

10. A notice says, “Return borrowed books by Friday to avoid a late fee.” What should a borrower do?

A. Return the books by Friday
B. Keep them until next month
C. Give them to another library
D. Pay before borrowing

11. The village planted trees along the road. Over time, the trees provided shade for people walking to school. What was one benefit?

A. The route became shadier
B. The road became shorter
C. The school moved closer
D. The trees stopped all traffic

12. A cyclist checked the brakes before riding downhill. Why was this a sensible step?

A. Working brakes help control speed
B. Brakes make hills disappear
C. It makes the bicycle lighter
D. It prevents all flat tires

13. The museum placed labels beside each artifact. Visitors could learn where objects came from and how they were used. What is the main purpose of the labels?

A. Explain the artifacts to visitors
B. Sell the artifacts
C. Hide the objects

D. Measure the museum walls

14. When Paolo could not solve a puzzle, he tried a different strategy and found the answer. What does this show?

A. Changing approaches can help solve problems
B. Puzzles have no solutions
C. Only one strategy is ever useful
D. Paolo stopped trying

15. A small leak continued overnight and left a puddle beneath the sink. What most likely caused the puddle?

A. Water dripped from the leak
B. The sink absorbed sunlight
C. The floor produced water
D. A window was painted

16. The coach praised the team for passing the ball and including every player. What behavior did the coach value?

A. Cooperation
B. Keeping the ball from teammates
C. Ignoring instructions
D. Winning at any cost

17. A student compared two sources before writing a report. Why might this improve the report?

A. The student can check facts and compare viewpoints
B. It guarantees both sources are identical
C. It removes the need to cite information
D. It makes the topic change automatically

18. The sign read “Trail closed: falling rocks.” What should visitors understand?

A. The trail is unsafe to use now
B. The trail is open only to cyclists
C. Rocks are available to take home
D. The trail leads to a museum

19. The old bridge was repaired before the rainy season. Workers strengthened its supports and cleared nearby drains. What was the likely goal?

A. Make the bridge safer and improve water flow
B. Make the bridge longer for racing
C. Stop all rain from falling
D. Turn the bridge into a school

20. A bird carried twigs to a tree and arranged them in a small cup. What was it likely doing?

A. Building a nest
B. Searching for a pond
C. Collecting stones for food
D. Escaping from a storm indoors

21. The class reused jars as pencil holders instead of throwing them away. What practice does this illustrate?

A. Reuse
B. Mining
C. Deforestation
D. Overfishing

22. A recipe lists ingredients before giving numbered directions. Where would a reader look to see what is needed?

A. The ingredients list
B. The final step only
C. The page number
D. The author’s biography

23. The article states that bees visit flowers and transfer pollen between them. What process can this help?

A. Pollination
B. Erosion
C. Evaporation
D. Digestion

24. Despite a small mistake in her first draft, Bea revised carefully and submitted a clear essay. What trait did Bea demonstrate?

A. Persistence
B. Carelessness
C. Impatience
D. Dishonesty

25. A town placed signs near a river asking visitors not to leave trash. What problem were the signs intended to address?

A. Litter in the river area
B. A shortage of boats
C. A lack of bridges
D. Too many trees

26. The farmer planted different crops in different seasons rather than growing one crop year-round. What benefit may this provide?

A. It can help maintain soil health and reduce some pest problems
B. It guarantees no rain will fall
C. It makes all crops grow at once
D. It removes the need for sunlight

27. Mika read the instructions twice before assembling the shelf. Why?

A. To understand each step and avoid mistakes
B. To make the shelf heavier
C. To change the instructions
D. To avoid using any tools

28. The train was crowded, but a passenger offered a seat to an older traveler. What quality did the passenger show?

A. Consideration
B. Confusion
C. Pride
D. Secrecy

29. The report uses a chart to show rainfall in each month. What is the chart's likely purpose?

A. Make monthly rainfall comparisons easier
B. Explain how to build a house
C. List every town resident
D. Replace the report's title

30. A child planted a seed, watered it, and placed the pot near a sunny window. What does the child expect?

A. The seed may grow into a plant
B. The pot will become a seed
C. The sunlight will turn to soil
D. The water will become a leaf

31. The notice says the clinic is closed on Sunday and open again Monday morning. When can patients next visit after Saturday?

A. Sunday
B. Monday morning
C. Saturday night
D. The following Friday

32. When the power went out, the family used a flashlight instead of candles. What safety choice did they make?

A. They chose a light without an open flame
B. They chose to enter a dark room
C. They left the house unlocked
D. They used more electricity

33. A student underlined unfamiliar terms while reading and looked them up afterward. What was the student doing?

A. Building vocabulary
B. Avoiding the text
C. Changing the author's ideas
D. Counting paragraphs

34. The seedling bent toward the window over several days. What does this observation suggest?

A. The plant was growing toward light
B. The window moved toward the plant
C. The soil became a seed
D. The plant stopped growing

35. A sign says “Please keep noise low; patients are resting.” Why is quiet requested?

A. To help patients rest
B. To keep visitors from reading
C. To prevent the building from moving
D. To make the hall brighter

36. The author describes a neighborhood market where neighbors share produce and recipes. What feeling is emphasized?

A. Community connection
B. Competition between planets
C. Fear of reading
D. Isolation from nature

37. A student’s answer was incorrect, so the teacher asked the student to explain the steps. What might the teacher be trying to identify?

A. Where the reasoning went wrong
B. Whether the student likes the classroom
C. How fast the student can write
D. Which book is newest

38. The storm warning advised residents to secure loose outdoor items. Why?

A. Strong winds could move them
B. The items would become food
C. The warning was about sunshine
D. Loose items attract rainbows

39. A family compared the prices and features of several lamps before buying one. What were they doing?

A. Making an informed choice
B. Avoiding all information
C. Repairing a road
D. Growing a garden

40. After reading a fable in which a patient tortoise wins a race, what lesson is most supported?

A. Steady effort can be valuable
B. Speed is the only useful quality
C. Races should never have rules
D. Animals cannot travel

41. The article explains that wetlands absorb excess rainwater and provide habitat for wildlife. What is one role of wetlands?

A. Reduce flooding risk and support animals
B. Increase desert area
C. Stop every storm
D. Create roads

42. A student wrote the date and title on a science notebook before recording observations. Why is this useful?

A. It keeps observations organized
B. It changes the experiment results
C. It removes the need to observe
D. It makes the notebook waterproof

43. The shopkeeper closed the door when the wind became very strong. What can be inferred?

A. The shopkeeper wanted to reduce exposure to the wind
B. The shopkeeper was opening a window
C. The wind had stopped
D. The shopkeeper was leaving for school

44. A student read the final paragraph, which restated the author's main points. What is that paragraph likely doing?

A. Concluding the text
B. Introducing a new character
C. Listing ingredients
D. Giving directions to a station

45. A family saved rainwater for watering plants during a dry week. What resource did they conserve?

A. Tap water
B. Electricity
C. Fuel
D. Paper

46. The instructions say to wash hands before handling food. What is the reason?

A. Help reduce the spread of germs
B. Make food cook faster
C. Change the food's color
D. Keep the room warmer

47. A book cover shows a child looking through a telescope under a starry sky. What topic is the book likely about?

A. Astronomy
B. Cooking
C. Gardening
D. Architecture

48. The village hall opened its doors during a heat wave so residents could cool down. What service did it provide?

A. A cool place for people during extreme heat
B. A new source of hot water
C. A closed road
D. A sports competition

49. A writer includes facts from a scientist and examples from local farmers. Why use both?

A. To support the topic with different kinds of evidence
B. To make the topic unrelated
C. To hide the main idea
D. To replace all explanations

50. A student noticed that a plant near the window grew more than one kept in a dark closet. What factor may explain the difference?

A. Light availability
B. The color of the pot only
C. The student's handwriting
D. The day of the week

51. The bus schedule lists departures at 7:10, 7:40, and 8:10. How often does it leave?

A. Every 15 minutes
B. Every 30 minutes
C. Every 40 minutes
D. Every hour

52. The article says a new footbridge connects two communities separated by a river. What change did the bridge make?

A. It made crossing between the communities easier
B. It moved the river
C. It ended all travel
D. It made both communities islands

53. The recipe says "stir until the mixture is smooth." What does "smooth" mean here?

A. Even, without noticeable lumps
B. Very cold
C. Brightly colored
D. Completely dry

54. A museum visitor followed arrows from the entrance to the exit. What did the arrows help the visitor do?

A. Find the intended route
B. Identify the oldest painting
C. Learn a language
D. Measure the room

55. A family bought reusable bottles to avoid using a new disposable bottle each day. What was their goal?

A. Reduce single-use waste
B. Increase litter
C. Use more packaging
D. Avoid drinking water

56. An article compares two kinds of clouds by their height and shape. How is the text organized?

A. By comparing and contrasting
B. By giving a recipe
C. By listing a schedule
D. By telling a joke

57. A student sees “fragile” on a package and handles it gently. What does “fragile” mean?

A. Easily broken
B. Very heavy
C. Made of cloth
D. Safe to drop

58. The rain stopped, but the playground remained wet. What is the best explanation?

A. Water had not yet dried or drained
B. The playground produced new rain
C. The sun was under the ground
D. The rain had never fallen

59. A notice asks visitors to return books to the correct shelf. What is the benefit?

A. Other readers can find the books more easily
B. Books become shorter
C. The library needs no catalog
D. Shelves become invisible

60. The article explains that exercise strengthens muscles over time when balanced with rest. What is the main idea?

A. Regular exercise and rest support muscle health
B. Rest should never follow exercise
C. Muscles grow without activity
D. Only athletes need muscles

61. A child heard thunder and moved indoors. Why was this a sensible choice?

A. Thunder can signal a nearby storm and lightning risk
B. Thunder means the sky is clear
C. Indoors is always warmer
D. Moving indoors causes the storm

62. The passage says the library has books, computers, and free tutoring. What does it suggest about the library?

A. It offers several learning resources
B. It is only a place to eat
C. It has no books
D. It is open only to teachers

63. A student checked the author and date of an online article before using it. What was the student evaluating?

A. The source’s credibility and currency
B. The font color only

C. The number of pictures

D. The computer’s battery

64. The team practiced passing before its game and communicated during play. What likely helped the team work well?

A. Preparation and communication

B. Avoiding all practice

C. Ignoring teammates

D. Changing the rules

65. A paragraph lists reasons to protect mangroves, including coastal shelter and wildlife habitat. What is its purpose?

A. Persuade readers to protect mangroves

B. Explain how to bake bread

C. Describe a train schedule

D. Tell how to build a toy

66. The shop ran out of umbrellas after three days of heavy rain. What does “ran out” mean?

A. Had none left

B. Found a new supply

C. Changed the price

D. Closed for lunch

67. A student read a passage, then summarized its key points in two sentences. What skill did the student use?

A. Summarizing

B. Copying

C. Predicting weather

D. Alphabetizing

68. The family took the longer route because it had sidewalks and less traffic. What mattered most to them?

A. A safer walking route

B. The shortest distance

C. The number of shops

D. The color of the road

69. A notice says “Bring a reusable container; refreshments will be provided.” What should a visitor bring?

A. A reusable container

B. A sleeping bag

C. A rain gauge

D. A library card only

70. The story ends with the character apologizing and repairing a neighbor’s fence. What does this action show?

A. Taking responsibility for harm caused

B. Avoiding the problem
C. Blaming the neighbor
D. Forgetting the event

Answer Key & Explanations

Use this section after completing the practice exam.

1. A ? Students help maintain a garden that supplies the cafeteria
The details describe students caring for a productive school garden.

2. A ? She wanted to be prepared for rain
A raincoat is useful preparation for expected showers.

3. A ? To meet students' study needs
The students' request explains the change.

4. A ? It was wet and possibly slippery
Mud forms in wet conditions and can make walking difficult.

5. A ? Balanced folds helped the plane fly farther
The observation connects even folds with a longer flight.

6. A ? Spaced review can support memory
Her experience supports studying in distributed sessions.

7. A ? The road closure
The passage directly names the road closure as the cause.

8. A ? Sunlight and water droplets in the air
Rain droplets and sunlight can create a rainbow.

9. A ? To understand how the word is used and said
A dictionary provides word definitions and pronunciations.

10. A ? Return the books by Friday
The notice sets Friday as the return deadline.

11. A ? The route became shadier
The passage states that the trees provided shade.

12. A ? Working brakes help control speed
Brakes are important for controlling a bicycle, especially downhill.

13. A ? Explain the artifacts to visitors
The labels provide background information about the objects.

14. A ? Changing approaches can help solve problems
Trying a new method helped him make progress.

15. A ? Water dripped from the leak
A leak can release water that collects below it.

16. A ? Cooperation
Passing and inclusion show teamwork.

17. A ? The student can check facts and compare viewpoints
Comparing sources helps confirm information and identify differences.

18. A ? The trail is unsafe to use now
The warning gives a safety reason for closing the trail.

19. A ? Make the bridge safer and improve water flow
The repairs address structural support and drainage before heavy rain.

20. A ? Building a nest
Twigs arranged in a cup are commonly used to build a nest.

21. A ? Reuse
Using an item again is reuse.

22. A ? The ingredients list
The ingredients list names the needed items.

23. A ? Pollination
Moving pollen between flowers can enable pollination.

24. A ? Persistence
She continued working and improved her draft.

25. A ? Litter in the river area
The signs directly ask visitors to prevent litter.

26. A ? It can help maintain soil health and reduce some pest problems
Crop rotation can support soil health and disrupt some pest cycles.

27. A ? To understand each step and avoid mistakes
Reviewing instructions helps clarify the steps.

28. A ? Consideration
Offering a seat shows thoughtfulness toward another person.

29. A ? Make monthly rainfall comparisons easier
A chart makes it easier to compare values across months.

30. A ? The seed may grow into a plant
Seeds can germinate when conditions such as water and warmth are suitable.

31. B ? Monday morning
The notice says the clinic reopens Monday morning.

32. A ? They chose a light without an open flame
A flashlight avoids the fire risk of an open candle flame.

33. A ? Building vocabulary
Looking up new terms helps develop vocabulary.

34. A ? The plant was growing toward light
Many plants grow toward a light source.

35. A ? To help patients rest
The sign gives patients’ rest as the reason.

36. A ? Community connection
Sharing food and recipes highlights connection among neighbors.

37. A ? Where the reasoning went wrong
Reviewing the steps can reveal a misunderstanding.

38. A ? Strong winds could move them
Wind can blow unsecured objects and create hazards.

39. A ? Making an informed choice
Comparing options helps people choose based on needs and cost.

40. A ? Steady effort can be valuable
The story highlights patience and steady effort.

41. A ? Reduce flooding risk and support animals
Wetlands can store water and provide habitat.

42. A ? It keeps observations organized
Dates and titles help organize and identify recorded observations.

43. A ? The shopkeeper wanted to reduce exposure to the wind
Closing the door can help keep strong wind outside.

44. A ? Concluding the text
A final restatement of key points functions as a conclusion.

45. A ? Tap water
Using collected rainwater reduces the need for tap water.

46. A ? Help reduce the spread of germs
Handwashing can reduce germs that may contaminate food.

47. A ? Astronomy
A telescope and stars suggest a book about space or astronomy.

48. A ? A cool place for people during extreme heat
The hall provided a cooler place during dangerous heat.

49. A ? To support the topic with different kinds of evidence
Both expert information and practical examples can support an explanation.

50. A ? Light availability
Plants generally need light for photosynthesis and healthy growth.

51. B ? Every 30 minutes
Each listed departure is thirty minutes after the previous one.

52. A ? It made crossing between the communities easier
The bridge provides a route across the river.

53. A ? Even, without noticeable lumps
In a recipe, smooth describes an even mixture with few or no lumps.

54. A ? Find the intended route
Directional arrows guide visitors through a route.

55. A ? Reduce single-use waste
Reusable bottles can reduce disposable bottle waste.

56. A ? By comparing and contrasting
Comparing height and shape highlights similarities or differences.

57. A ? Easily broken
Fragile describes something that can break easily.

58. A ? Water had not yet dried or drained
Puddles and surfaces can stay wet after rainfall ends.

59. A ? Other readers can find the books more easily
Correct shelving keeps materials organized for everyone.

60. A ? Regular exercise and rest support muscle health
The sentence links exercise and rest to muscle health.

61. A ? Thunder can signal a nearby storm and lightning risk
Thunder is a warning to seek shelter from lightning.

62. A ? It offers several learning resources
The listed services are all learning resources.

63. A ? The source’s credibility and currency
Author and date help readers judge reliability and timeliness.

64. A ? Preparation and communication
Practice and communication support teamwork.

65. A ? Persuade readers to protect mangroves
The supporting reasons advocate protecting mangroves.

66. A ? Had none left
To run out of something means the supply is gone.

67. A ? Summarizing
A summary briefly states the most important ideas.

68. A ? A safer walking route
Sidewalks and less traffic suggest safety was their priority.

69. A ? A reusable container
The notice directly requests a reusable container.

70. A ? Taking responsibility for harm caused
The character acknowledges the harm and tries to fix it.